

Problem Statement Template

Day 5 · Activity 1 handout. One line at a time. **Do not skip "Success looks like."** Every claim in "We know this because" must be tagged by evidence tier (Observed / Reported / Inferred / AI-generated).

Problem statement — [short handle]

Who — [persona role + context]

Currently — [observed behavior, with frequency]

Which causes — [measurable consequence]

Because — [root cause, from 5 Whys]

We know this because — [evidence, tagged by tier]

Success looks like — [the change we'd see if the problem is solved]

The bar to clear

A senior engineer should be able to **scope from this without a clarifying call**. If any line is vague or secretly proposes a solution, rewrite it.